

Same Event, Different Historian Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • History • 30-40 min

Category	History	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	same-event-different-historian

Big idea: Interpretation depends on lens and selection.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students compare how historical lenses shape explanation.

Student Prompt

Inspect Same Event, Different Historian Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Same Event, Different Historian Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Two historians explaining the same protest, invention, or revolution differently. Mark what the source shows, what it omits, whose perspective appears, and what claim it can responsibly support.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Same Event, Different Historian Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Source packets that foreground economics, leadership, culture, or ordinary people. Mark what the source shows, what it omits, whose perspective appears, and what claim it can responsibly support.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Same Event, Different Historian Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A claim comparison chart: evidence used, emphasis, and implied values. Mark what the source shows, what it omits, whose perspective appears, and what claim it can responsibly support.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Interpretation depends on lens and selection.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Same Event, Different Historian Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Same Event, Different Historian Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Are some historical interpretations better than others?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to History.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how interpretation depends on lens and selection.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Are some historical interpretations better than others?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: Two historians explaining the same protest, invention, or revolution differently.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Two historians explaining the same protest, invention, or revolution differently.
- Source packets that foreground economics, leadership, culture, or ordinary people.
- A claim comparison chart: evidence used, emphasis, and implied values.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/same-event-different-historian/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/same-event-different-historian/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/same-event-different-historian/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Assign each group a different lens.
2. Groups write a three-sentence explanation of the event.
3. Groups present and underline what they selected as important.
4. Students identify which facts were shared and which interpretations differed.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Are some historical interpretations better than others?
- Does perspective make history biased or meaningful?
- Can there be one true history?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...